

PAVAN KUMAR NAYAKANTI

Platform Engineering Director | Kubernetes | CI/CD | Python Automation | Observability | SRE | Regulated FinTech

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SUMMARY

Platform SRE and engineering leader with 20+ years designing, deploying, and operating containerised platforms in regulated FinTech environments -- Kubernetes, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions), Python-based automation, and full-stack observability (Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace). Delivered 40%+ MTTR reduction, 600% deployment cadence improvement, and AI-enabled automation with enterprise guardrails and HITL controls for ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

 600% Deployment Cadence Python-orchestrated CI/CD platform (modeas) -- 200+ builds/hr via Jenkins and Docker, eliminating 10,000+ manual ops hours annually.	 40%+ MTTR Reduction Full-stack observability (Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace) + Python/Ansible automated remediation for ADP's cloud platform.	 SRE Org: 4 to 35 Engineers Scaled ADP's SRE org across India, Canada, and the US; built Schwab's 18-member platform engineering team from zero.	 98% Onboarding Cut Robo Deployment Framework -- Python/PowerShell CI/CD governing 250+ apps across 60+ teams, cutting onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours.
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EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist -- Cloud Practice & SRE Lead

IRIS Software -- India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

Sep 2020 -- Present | Hyderabad / Pune, India

- Designed and operated **containerised applications on Kubernetes with Helm** for ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO -- zero-downtime rolling deployments, automated health checks, and rollback gates across cloud-native financial platforms.
- Built and maintained **CI/CD pipelines** (Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps) for 200+ builds/deployments per hour via the modeas platform -- eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and accelerating deployment cadence by 600%.
- Owned full-stack **platform observability** using Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, and Splunk -- metrics, logs, dashboards, and alert runbooks enabling automated Python/Ansible remediation and 40%+ MTTR reduction.
- Standardised **Python-based automation frameworks** and Ansible playbooks for incident remediation, deployment validation, and capacity monitoring across three banking clients.
- Deployed **AI-enabled automation** for BMO -- GenAI risk summarisation assistants on AWS Bedrock with **enterprise guardrails, HITL controls**, and compliance-grade audit logging in a regulated environment.
- Led end-to-end AWS cloud migration for BMO (CDK, ECS Fargate, Lambda) with HA/DR architecture from day one; drove **FinOps capacity planning** and rightsizing across the AWS estate.
- Scaled ADP's SRE organisation from 4 to 35 engineers across India, Canada, and the US; built Charles Schwab's 18-member platform engineering team from the ground up with Kubernetes-native reliability and production support practices.

Automation Technology Specialist

IRIS Software -- Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

Jun 2018 -- Sep 2020 | Toronto, Canada

- Established SRE and **platform engineering principles** within RBC's DevSecOps programme -- observability standards, reliability-focused deployment gates, and incident classification frameworks across 250+ applications in a regulated banking environment.
- Designed and delivered the Robo Deployment Framework -- **Python/PowerShell CI/CD** orchestration platform with built-in SOX/GDPR audit trails, reducing application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction).
- Inducted **DORA framework** metrics and enabled SAST/DAST/IAST pipeline-native security scanning (SonarQube, Jenkins, JFrog, GitHub) across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance -- driving measurable engineering health improvement across 60+ teams.

Automation Architect

IRIS Software -- Toronto, Canada (Insurance & Capital Markets)

Feb 2017 -- Jun 2018 | Toronto, Canada

- Designed fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines using **Kubernetes and Helm** for capital markets platforms; built **Python-based automation frameworks** automating 80+ applications across Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, and Mainframe stacks.
- Pioneered Cognitive and Intelligent Process Automation (CPA/IPA) -- expanding the automation model beyond RPA with AI-assisted and prompt-driven workflows across Insurance and Capital Markets domains.

Sr. SDET -- QA, Automation & Production Engineering

Microsoft Corporation -- India

Jul 2007 -- Dec 2014 | Hyderabad, India

- Dual mandate as Production Engineering owner and Sr. SDET for global Sales and Marketing platforms -- accountable for system availability, RCA, CI/CD automation, and **Linux/Windows infrastructure operations** with 99.99% uptime over 7 years across US, EMEA, and APAC subsidiaries.

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence
Woolf University

2024 **General Management Program (GMP)**
ISB Hyderabad

2022 **M.Sc in Computer Science**
Osmania University

2002

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)

Cloud Native Computing Foundation -- 2025

Certified Site Reliability Engineer (iSRE)

iSRE Institute

Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)

Microsoft

AWS Certified Solutions Architect -- Associate (SAA-C01)

Amazon Web Services -- 2026

Google Cloud Certified -- Professional Cloud Architect (PCA)

Google Cloud -- 2026

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

Project Management Institute